

Communicative English

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7 Cs of Communication

Introduction

- The seven C's of communication are a list of principles for written and spoken communications to ensure that they are effective.
- The seven C's are:
- Courtesy
- Consideration
- Clarity
- Correctness
- Conciseness
- Concreteness
- Completeness.

Courtesy

- Courtesy is the most important quality of the messenger. “Everyone gains where courtesy reigns” is an old but wise saying.
- Courtesy means politeness.
- It is an attitude that shows respect for others.
- It helps in building goodwill.
- It is not enough to use polite expressions like “thank you”, “kindly”, “we appreciate”, “please” etc. It must have a courteous tone too.
- To achieve courtesy, keep in mind the following points:
- Be sincere. – Use expressions that show respect. – Be thoughtful and appreciative of the receiver’s point of view. – Avoid humor. – Avoid discriminatory language i.e., race, color, gender, creed etc.

Consideration

- Consideration is to put you in the place of the receiver.
- It means preparing every message with the message receiver in mind
- This mode of consideration is called “you attitude”
- When you are truly considerate, you try to show sincere regard for his interests and benefits.
- To be considerate, the following points should be kept in mind: – See your material from your reader’s point of view. – Focus on “you” instead of “we”
- Consider the needs and problems of the receiver.

Clarity

- Clarity is the soul of a message.
- It means the accurate transfer of ideas from the sender's side to the receiver.
- Every message should be conveyed in a clear manner.
- Clarity comes through clear thinking. A good message shows the idea directly and clearly.
- A writer should not start the message unless he knows how (use of language) and what (central idea) he wants to say.
- A message written in the simple and ordinary language is always natural and appreciable.

Correctness

- Language experts say that writing is an art and difficult.
- There is no shortcut to being a good writer.
- It is learned through consistent practice and constant struggle.
- The message being communicated must be correct.
- Correctness refers to correct grammar, punctuation, and spelling.
- To achieve correctness-
- Check the accuracy of facts and figures.
- Check mistakes in punctuation, grammar, and capitalization.
- Check misspelled words.

Conciseness

- The beauty of diction/language lies in its conciseness.
- Conciseness means brief and complete
- Be as brief as possible.
- But it must not be so brief as to be discourteous.
- Conciseness is a pre-requisite to effective messages
- A concise message saves time and expense for both sender and receiver.
- To achieve conciseness, observe the following suggestions:
- Remove the wordy expressions. Include only relevant material.
Avoid unnecessary repetition

Concreteness

- Communicating concretely means being specific, meaningful and clear.
- Vague and general messages result in no response.
- It helps the receiver to understand the exact idea.
- Concrete use of available facts and figures adds to the authenticity of the message.
- To achieve concreteness, consider the following ways:
- Use clear and image building words.
- Use specific facts and figures.
- Use active voice than passive voice.

Completeness

- A message should be complete to bring the desired result.
- A complete message contains all the facts required by the receiver.
- The receiver's reaction to an incomplete message is often unfavorable.
- An incomplete message shows negligence and carelessness of the writer.
- For completeness follow these guidelines:
- Remember the five W's (what, when, where, why, who) and how.
- Provide all the necessary information. – Answer all the questions asked.
- Include additional information, if desired

It can be said that awareness of seven C's discussed are the key to effective communication and make you a good communicator